

# Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

## Audio Remixing

A remixed song is, simply speaking, an alternative, augmented version of a song: multiple other tracks, music samples, loops, and sound effects are added to the original. Since remixes are so popular these days, you might just seem silly if you don't know how it's done. Here are some terms to help you not seem silly.

**Console:** Also known as a mixing deck, it is the control panel for making the changes to the audio track.

**Synthesizer:** An instrument that can be used for generating new sounds from raw audio material such as waveforms—and also for generating original sounds. **Filter:** A circuit that carries hundreds of knobs, used for eliminating certain frequencies and letting other frequencies pass through.

**Scratching:** The technique of moving a vinyl record to and fro by hand on the mixer with the phono cartridge for creating different rhythmic sound patterns.

**EQ (Equalisation):** The process of altering, cutting, or boosting the levels of individual frequency bands within an audio signal using a number of filters. This control can be simple or highly complex, depending on software or hardware.

**Fader (Slider):** This acts as a control device used for the precise manipulation of audio levels—something like an advanced volume control. **BPM:** The unit that defines the pace of music—beats per minute.

**Usage:** Last night, I got a chance to remix some songs at a local discotheque on the DJ's *console* hooked up to their *synthesiser*. Whenever I increased the *BPM*—or used the *fader* to change the track, the audience would roar like crazy! I need to improve my *scratching* technique and learn *EQ* by working on *filter* adjustments.

# Wild Wild Web

## So Call Us Warped

There's this sad site at [www.avazo.com](http://www.avazo.com). From the Welcome Page: "Welcome to the online web magazine, modern digital media newspaper, blog—[www.avazo.com](http://www.avazo.com). This is a great portal for articles publications and discussions, demonstration all kind of images legal, acceptable and pleasant for the whole family. You could publish any information about you in the modern world, how you live and what you like! We accept and will publish your personal opinion and you could see what other people think about it. "What you'll find here... Everything I want to include, as

an editor and owner of this Internet digital magazine." We're calling it "sad" because it's so *genuine*, so *innocent*, so depressingly naive. And it's so sad, it's funny. Call us warped.

The editor and owner of that Internet digital magazine is Russian. This, therefore, seems to be a site for Russians in America to feel sort of American and democratic, to feel free and brave. A sample from the "Last Additions" (sic): "Buying a home, although is a good investment and it can put a tremendous strain on your finances. Actually the monetary cost of buying a

house or a piece of property is so large that most people would not be able to pay for it straight from their pockets. This is where a mortgage comes into play." Russians in America, unite! You have nothing to lose but your debt! Learn from fellow Russians about buying property in America, owning your own money, even that capitalist banks will give you a loan!

Don't miss "Google: Good or Evil?" in the Articles section.

You need to have a genuinely heartless sense of humour to be able to laugh at the site. Don't forward the joke—people will like you less.

anyway, since those that go there don't come back).

## FAIR DEAL

# Let's Get Bad This Christmas

It's amazing what fathers will go through for their prized offspring. It's also amazing how said offspring can go into blithering-idiot-mode with alarming regularity. A combination of the two can lead to one ticked-off parent, as one wayward 15-year old in Canada was soon to learn.

The father—whose nickname on eBay is k\_lid—still loves his son though, and plans on getting him another game for his Wii—"something like *Barbie Island Princess*", he contemplates. Punish kid, make a pile, punish kid again. You can't make up happier Christmas stories.

## FROM DINGO TO LIMBU

# What Is In A Name, Really?

You probably haven't heard of these recently-up Web sites: Squidoo, Kayak, Pownce,

Scandoo, Foonance, Kelkoo. Actually, you wouldn't recollect the names even if you'd stumbled upon them.

In this, the Web 2.0 era, a new site is launched every fortnight (they're all in beta, but no matter; they exist). Why do these sites come up with the most out-of-the-world names, which sometimes sound goofy, and are sometimes unpronounceable? What a group of directors used to do behind closed doors earlier is now done... untrained monkeys armed with typewriters. (No, that was speculation; we do a lot of that in this space). Actually, the thanks go to online services like Dot-o-mator.com: no more wasting time. Just couple of clicks and voila... a new domain and Web 2.0 site name!

In the past, sites had names that actually *meant* something, and those names were associated with a brand name and with services offered. (For example, god.com is a spiritual site.) Some big names might seem like exceptions, though, for example, Yahoo!. But then,

# Of Change And Small Change

Bidding farewell to Deepak Ajwani as Editor—in fact, as a member of this organisation—was a mixed affair. It was sad for most of us; one or two women wept the way some women do when the time comes to say good-bye. The *chaiwala*, however, was glad, because Deepak never had never given him a tip—we know because he told us.

The outgoing (rather, the out-went) editor had won our minds and hearts by virtue of his genuineness, his big heart, his lack of attitude and ego issues, and his unwillingness to wield the stick of discipline (the above, not in any order—really!). But in particular reference to the last point, we should mention that Nimish and Robert got to play *Quake*, Ram got to sleep, Samir got to use his PSP, Bhaskar got to do his Wikipedia edits, Asfaq

got to chat, Vijay got to surf for exotic pictures, etc. etc.—*during official, paid, office hours*. Still, we should reinforce the idea that this thing about Deepak's not having been strict about discipline was *not* the biggest reason for our loving him.

Raaabo now manages the things Deepak did, and we'll soon begin to treat him in this space the way we've been treating Deepak. For example, fun shall often be poked at him, and gentle ridicule shall sometimes be directed his way.

We collectively gifted Deepak a good phone, because it's better to give than to receive (*and when you know you won't receive if you ask, it's even better to quietly give*).

We do know that the *chaiwala* has no complaints with Raaabo, though—he tips enough for all of us!

after some soul-searching, illumination dawns: Yahoo! Is an expression of joy, ostensibly upon receiving an e-mail. (At the time the name was conceived, people just loved to receive mail.) Google refers to one googol Web pages; Googol means 1 followed by 100 zeroes. Then there are the self-explanatory names: Amazon (which obviously refers to the vastness of the site, just like the Amazon basin);

Digg (referring, doubtless, to the digging up of information); eBay (who can possibly not know that electronic commerce began in the Bay area?); etc.

But Yokld, doodlekit, Bykaee, Yamli, Sphinn, Yuku... ? The only way out we can see is to impose the following Three Commandments upon new domain registrars:

▣ The name of your domain shall roll freely

off the tongue and shall not generate in the listener the question "Beg pardon?"

▣ At least five minutes of thought, with valid brain activity being measured and certified by an EMG, shall have gone into the creation of the name.

▣ When in public, you shall pin to your breast pocket a badge bearing your name following the name of your site. ■

# Blog WATCH

Serious issues this month. What's the connection between social networking and large portals? Then, the OLPC project still runs strong in blogging circles... and then, what's gotten into the head of the Chinese government?

Jonathan Bradford and Ian Leader

<http://tinyurl.com/2ogfxk>

[http://www.readwriteweb.com/archives/online\\_accounting\\_google\\_apps.php](http://www.readwriteweb.com/archives/online_accounting_google_apps.php)

...So what's next for Google Apps? What might be the next killer app? We think it will be an accounting system and in this article we will outline why. There are strong benefits to an online accounting service in Google Apps—both to users and to the targeted advertising-driven business of Google...every site. What does this have to do with the portals?

...Google could bring significant expertise to online accounting, thanks to their ability to deliver simple, effective online applications with high-performance and reliable infrastructure.

Steve Rubel

<http://tinyurl.com/24n7va>

<http://www.micropersuasion.com/2007/12/wikipedia-and-w.html>

Google announced last night they are starting a project called knol that will allow anyone to create wiki-like pages on topics. In particular, Google is encouraging people who know a particular subject to write an "authoritative" article about it. The search engine will not vet any of the content, however, they will prioritize

the most credible entries and rank them first in search results. It remains unclear how Google is measuring credibility—a scary thought.

...My initial take on this is that knols are going to kill Wikipedia—but it will take time. This theory, however, hinges on whether people actually start creating knols, but I believe they will. Here are several reasons why Wikipedia and Wikia are dead ...

Mark 'Rizzn' Hopkins

<http://tinyurl.com/2gdjvs>

<http://mashable.com/2007/12/13/citizen-journalism-dangerous-and-irresponsible/>

Why are Thomas, Hazinski, and a growing number of mainstream journalists suddenly saying that those of us who are in the New Media shouldn't be trusted? Has there been some major faux pas that we've committed and didn't know? Did the bloggerati collectively all break one of the "unwritten ethical standards" recently?

No, the impetus for the criticism lately from all sides isn't something we did, it's something CNN did. Those that remember the controversy I caused a few weeks ago even intimating that New Media could be getting a black eye from the Republican YouTube-CNN debates are likely groaning right now, because what I predicted is starting to come to pass...